



Enter the Shadow

Monolith Productions takes gaming all-out with their Nemesis system in the upcoming 'Shadow of Mordor'. Take a look! <http://dgit.in/somordor>

Oldest multiplication table found

Constructed from bamboo, the oldest decimal multiplication table dating back to 350 BC has been found in China. <http://dgit.in/1ipePvc>

Web Watch - R.I.P FB

Read on to know how Facebook got its knickers in a twist over a study that predicted its obsolescence and other developments in the web arena

Facebook may lose 80% of users by 2017: Princeton Study

A recent study by researchers at Princeton University has revealed that Facebook is likely to lose 80 percent of its users between 2015 to 2017. Researchers arrived at the conclusion based on a study of charts produced by Google Trends which showed that Facebook searches peaked in December 2012, but have been declining ever since.

The study conducted by John Cannarella and Joshua Spechler was modelled after the mathematical adoption rates of communicable diseases, which typically peak before declining.

The researchers then compared the growth curve of other online social networks with Facebook. According to the report, Facebook which turns 10 in February has survived far longer than its rivals, MySpace and Bebo. It was observed that users begin to lose interest in any service after a few years.

The report added that there's been a decrease in the social network's daily users, driven by teenagers deserting the site. Teenagers are leaving Facebook in favour of messaging services such as Twitter and Snapchat.

Social media expert Michael McQueen called it the Levi's Effect. McQueen added that the site has been overtaken by people 30 years of age and above, as teenagers log off. Facebook's CFO David Ebersman also confirmed that the company "did see a decrease in daily users, specifi-

cally among younger teens." It is reported that the social network lost nearly \$18 billion of its market value due to teenagers leaving the site.

Facebook mocks study predicting its extinction

In response to Princeton University's study, Facebook predicted the imminent demise of the social network, with its own satirical prediction that the University itself would be out of business by 2021.

Mike Develin, a data scientist at Facebook, wrote in a note: "Princeton will have only half its current enrolment by 2018, and by 2021 it will have no students at all." Devlin claimed he had analysed several data points that includes volume of queries on Google Scholar matching the query "Princeton".

Devlin's analysis revealed that the percentage of these queries had dipped significantly since 2000.

"In keeping with the scientific principle 'correlation equals causation,' our research unequivocally demonstrated that Princeton may be in danger of disappearing entirely," Develin added.

Further ridiculing Princeton University's study, Devlin continued: "While we are concerned for Princeton University, we are even more concerned about the fate of the planet — Google Trends for 'air' have also been declining steadily, and our projections show that by the year 2060 there will be no air left."

Fastest broadband speed of 1.4 Tbps recorded in London

Networking company Alcatel-Lucent and BT performed a data transfer test in which speeds of 1.4 terabits per second were reached. This can be translated into 44 uncom-

when compared to the current broadband networks available in the UK. This also proves that high speeds can be achieved on the current hardware of fibre-optics installed without the need to upgrade them.

Just to put the above number in context, according to last



Alcatel-Lucent reached speeds of 1.4 terabits per second

pressed HD films in just one second. The test was done over a distance of 255 miles (410 kms approximately) between London's BT tower and BT's Adastral Park in Ipswich between October to November 2013. The data was transferred over existing fibre-optic cables that are already installed in major parts of the UK.

A 'flexigrid' infrastructure was implemented for the test to create an 'alien super channel' which consists of seven channels, all of which transmit 200 gigabits per seconds, combining for a total capacity of 1.4 terabits of data per second. This is a huge achievement as it is a marked 42.5 percent increase in data transmission efficiency

year's reports, India's average broadband speed is 1.3 Mbps. Chew on that.

South Korea ahead in 5G race

In January, South Korea's Science ministry announced a \$1.5 billion plan to upgrade its network by 2020. Even Huawei and European Union had set the same deadline to upgrade to 5G but their budgets (\$600 million and \$950 million, respectively) sound meagre as compared to the one announced by South Korea. The country's ministry, in a statement, said, "Now it is time to take preemptive action to develop 5G."

Various countries around the world have been eying the next